India–Mozambique: Building Bridges, Shaping Futures

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FOREWORD

India and Mozambique share a longstanding relationship shaped by diplomatic engagement, growing trade, investment interests and expanding opportunities for business cooperation. Mozambique's strategic location along the Indian Ocean, natural resource base, agricultural potential and emerging industrial sectors, combined with India's expanding capabilities across manufacturing, pharmaceuticals, infrastructure, technology and services, create significant scope for deeper economic engagement between the two countries. Strengthening these linkages can support greater market access, investment partnerships, technology cooperation, value addition and enterprise-level collaboration.

Mozambique's agricultural resources and potential for food processing and value addition, together with opportunities in energy and industrial development, provide avenues for Indian enterprises to explore long-term partnerships. At the same time, Mozambican businesses can benefit from India's diversified industrial ecosystem, affordable technologies, skilled talent, healthcare capabilities, manufacturing base and large consumer market. Realising this potential requires reliable market intelligence, stronger institutional connections and practical mechanisms that can help businesses identify credible opportunities and convert them into sustainable commercial partnerships.

This paper seeks to provide a structured perspective on the India–Mozambique economic relationship, with particular attention to bilateral trade, priority sectors, investment opportunities, market-entry considerations, business matchmaking and institutional cooperation. It also examines practical areas of collaboration in pharmaceuticals and healthcare, agriculture and agro-processing, energy and solar, electric mobility, infrastructure, logistics, technology transfer and startup development. The paper further considers mechanisms through which industry-led engagement can help strengthen commercial linkages and facilitate greater participation of enterprises from both countries.

CCI India can play an important role as a facilitator, connector and knowledge partner by bringing together Indian and Mozambican businesses, industry associations, government institutions, investors and other relevant stakeholders. Through targeted B2B matchmaking, business delegations, sector-focused dialogues, market intelligence, startup support, technology partnerships and investment facilitation, CCI India can contribute to creating practical pathways for bilateral business engagement. The proposed focus on supporting Mozambican startups, encouraging investment partnerships and facilitating high-level institutional dialogue can further strengthen the foundation for sustained economic cooperation.

CCI India remains committed to strengthening international business partnerships and supporting greater trade, investment, technology and enterprise cooperation between India and Mozambique, while contributing to a stronger and more structured framework for long-term bilateral economic engagement.



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MOZAMBIQUE

> Explore coastal beauty and culture, where ocean life shapes traditions.



Introduction

Mozambique is a coastal country located in southeastern Africa with its capital at Maputo. It lies along the Indian Ocean and occupies a strategic position on major maritime trade routes connecting Africa with Asia and the Middle East.

Mozambique is richly endowed with natural resources and has emerged as one of Africa's most promising energy and mineral economies. India and Mozambique share long-standing historical and commercial links dating back to ancient Indian Ocean trade, and India maintains a High Commission in Maputo to strengthen bilateral cooperation.

Basic Facts

The capital city of Mozambique is Maputo. The country follows a republican system of government and is a member of the African Union, SADC and the Commonwealth. Mozambique has one of Africa's longest coastlines, which plays a vital role in its ports, fisheries, tourism and international trade. The country is highly resource-rich, particularly in coal, natural gas, aluminum, heavy sands and agricultural land

GDP (Gross Domestic Product)

Mozambique's nominal GDP is estimated to be around US$ 20–22 billion. The country is classified as a lower-middle-income economy with strong long-term growth potential driven by energy, mining and infrastructure development. However, poverty levels remain high and economic growth is sensitive to global commodity prices, climatic risks and external debt conditions.

Trade with India (Bilateral Trade – in Billions)

India is among Mozambique's most important trading partners. The bilateral trade between India and Mozambique stands at approximately US$ 2.0–2.4 billion annually. India's imports from Mozambique account for the major share at around US$ 1.6–1.9 billion, while India's exports to Mozambique are valued at approximately US$ 0.4–0.5 billion. The trade balance is heavily in Mozambique's favour due to large natural resource exports to India.

Culture and Heritage

Mozambique's culture blends African, Arab, and Portuguese influences, reflected in its music, dance, and coastal traditions. Diverse ethnic groups maintain unique customs and crafts such as wood carving and textiles. Religion includes Christianity, Islam, and indigenous beliefs, often practiced together, shaping the country's cultural identity.

Economy

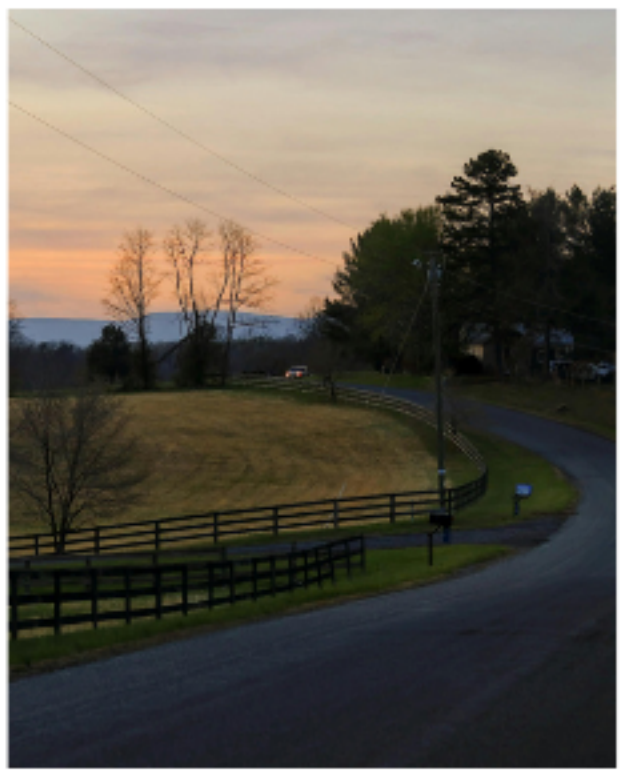
Mozambique's economy is based largely on natural resources, agriculture, mining, energy, fisheries and services. Agriculture employs a majority of the population and major crops include cassava, maize, sugarcane, cotton, cashew nuts and rice. The mining sector is highly significant, with exports of coal, graphite, heavy mineral sands and aluminum. In recent years, Mozambique has gained global importance due to its massive offshore natural gas discoveries, which are expected to transform the economy over the long term. The services sector, particularly ports, logistics, construction and tourism, is also expanding steadily

Import & Export from India

Mozambique exports large quantities of coking coal, non-coking coal, graphite, pulses, timber and cashew nuts to India. Coal alone forms the bulk of Mozambique's export earnings from India. On the other hand, India exports pharmaceuticals, rice, machinery, vehicles, refined petroleum products, iron and steel, electrical equipment, chemicals and textiles to Mozambique. Indian medicines play a vital role in Mozambique's healthcare sector due to affordability and availability.

Strategic Importance & Key Observations

Mozambique holds strong strategic importance for India due to its coastal location on the Indian Ocean, vast coal reserves and massive natural gas resources. For India, Mozambique is a crucial source of energy security and raw materials, especially coal and gas. There are strong investment opportunities for Indian companies in mining, LNG, power generation, transmission, ports, railways, agro-processing, fertilizers, healthcare and infrastructure development. While Mozambique faces challenges related to debt, security concerns in the northern gas-rich regions, and climate vulnerability, its long-term economic outlook remains highly promising.



Culture & Economic Ties with India

India and Mozambique share deep-rooted cultural and commercial ties due to centuries-old trade links and the presence of an Indian-origin community involved in trade, retail, pharmaceuticals, manufacturing and logistics. India is also a significant development partner for Mozambique and has extended Lines of Credit for infrastructure, agriculture, power and ICT projects. Mozambique actively participates in India's ITEC and ICCR training and scholarship programmes, strengthening institutional and human resource cooperation.

Population

Mozambique has a population of approximately 34 million people as of 2024. It has a young and rapidly growing population, with most citizens dependent on agriculture and informal economic activities for their livelihoods. Urbanization is increasing steadily, particularly in Maputo, Beira and Nampula.

1. Country Profile of Mozambique

1.1 Identity and key facts

Item	Detail	Status
Official name	Republic of Mozambique (Republica de Mocambique)	Standard reference
Capital	Maputo (also the largest city)	Standard reference
Independence	25 June 1975 (from Portugal)	MEA: India opened its mission on this date
Head of state	President Daniel Chapo, following the October 2024 elections	World Bank, Oct 2025; date of inauguration to be verified
Political system	Republic with a directly elected President, who is head of state and government; unicameral Assembly of the Republic	To be verified against the Constitution
Area	About 799,000 sq km in total (land area about 786,000 sq km)	Encyclopaedia Britannica; UN. Sources differ slightly
Official language	Portuguese; Bantu languages widely spoken (Emakhuwa, Xichangana, Cisena, Elomwe and others)	Standard reference
Currency	Metical (MZN)	Britannica; Bank of Mozambique to confirm
Population	35.6 million (2025, estimate)	UN WPP 2024 Revision; World Bank
Time zone	Central Africa Time (UTC+2)	Standard reference

1.2 Location, borders and coastline

Mozambique lies in south-eastern Africa on the Indian Ocean. Its eastern boundary is the Mozambique Channel, which separates it from Madagascar and, further north, the Comoros. On land it borders Tanzania to the north; Malawi and Zambia to the north-west; Zimbabwe to the west; and South Africa and Eswatini to the south-west and south.

The coastline runs for roughly 2,500 km. This is long relative to the country's economy and is the basis for its role as a transit country for cargo bound for inland economies.

1.3 Administrative structure

Mozambique is divided into 11 provinces: Niassa, Cabo Delgado, Nampula, Zambezia, Tete, Manica, Sofala, Inhambane, Gaza, Maputo Province and Maputo City, which has provincial status. Provinces are divided into districts, with municipalities (autarquias) in urban areas. Provincial governors and district administrators form part of the state administration, and local government reform has been under discussion in recent years.

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Region	Provinces	Business relevance (indicative)
South	Maputo City, Maputo Province, Gaza, Inhambane	Capital region, Maputo/Matola port complex, links to South Africa, aluminium and industrial activity, largest consumer market
Centre	Sofala, Manica, Zambezia, Tete	Beira port and corridor to Zimbabwe; Tete coal and Zambezi hydropower; agriculture in Zambezia
North	Nampula, Niassa, Cabo Delgado	Nacala port and corridor to Malawi/Zambia; agriculture (Nampula); Rovuma-basin gas developments in Cabo Delgado

1.4 Political system and governance context

Mozambique has been a multiparty republic since the 1990 Constitution and the 1992 General Peace Agreement that ended the civil war. The World Bank notes that a new government took office after the contested October 2024 elections, with President Daniel Chapo prioritising transparency, institutional efficiency, economic reform and inclusive development.

For business readers, three governance points matter. First, the World Bank's 2025 Enterprise Survey found that 30% of respondents named corruption as their biggest obstacle, and Mozambique's 2025 Corruption Perceptions Index score and rank fell considerably. Second, security in Cabo Delgado has affected the gas sector, and the post-election period saw civil disruption that weighed on activity. Third, fiscal pressure is constraining public spending. These are conditions to be reflected in project structuring, not reasons in themselves to rule out engagement.

1.5 Major cities

City	Province	Population (2025 est.)	Commercial significance
Maputo (incl. metropolitan area)	Maputo City / Province	About 3.2 million (UN-based estimate)	Capital, financial and administrative centre, port
Nampula	Nampula	About 0.89 million	Northern commercial hub, agriculture, rail link to Nacala
Beira	Sofala	About 0.61 million	Central port; Beira Corridor to Zimbabwe
Chimoio	Manica	About 0.45 million	On the Beira Corridor; agriculture
Quelimane	Zambezia	About 0.44 million	Agricultural province; river port
Tete	Tete	About 0.42 million	Coal-mining centre; Zambezi crossing

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City	Province	Population (2025 est.)	Commercial significance
Nacala	Nampula	About 0.27 million	Deep-water port; Nacala Corridor
Pemba	Cabo Delgado	About 0.26 million	Gateway to the northern gas region

1.6 Major ports

Port	Location	Hinterland / role
Maputo (with Matola terminals)	South	Maputo Corridor to Gauteng and Mpumalanga in South Africa; bulk and container cargo; Eswatini
Beira	Centre	Beira Corridor to Zimbabwe and, further, Zambia and the DRC
Nacala	North	Natural deep-water port; Nacala Corridor to Malawi and Zambia
Pemba, Quelimane and others	North / centre	Regional and coastal traffic; Pemba is a supply base for northern gas activity

1.7 Climate and geography

The climate is tropical to subtropical, with a hot, wet season from about October to March and a cooler, drier season from about April to September. Rainfall and temperature vary from north to south and between coast and highlands.

Geography runs from a wide coastal plain, which covers much of the south and centre, to plateaus and mountains in the north and west. Major rivers include the Zambezi, Limpopo, Save and Rovuma, and Lake Niassa (Lake Malawi) lies on the north-western border. The Zambezi supports the Cahora Bassa hydropower scheme.

1.8 Natural resources

Mozambique's resource base is broad. The table sets out the main categories at a high level. Each is developed with evidence which also tests whether reserves translate into investable opportunities.

Resource	Where	Existing activity (high level)
Natural gas / LNG	Rovuma Basin, offshore Cabo Delgado; Pande-Temane onshore in Inhambane	Coral South floating LNG in operation; other Rovuma projects affected by security and delays
Coal	Tete Province (Moatize)	Coking and thermal coal mining, rail and port export

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